Project Plan Template · Expert version

A project plan template brings the essentials of a project into one place: goals, scope, deliverables, tasks, owners, dates and milestones. Use it to plan the work, agree it with stakeholders and track progress.

How to use this template

1. Fill in the Overview tab: goal, scope, deliverables, budget and success criteria.
2. Break the work into phases and tasks on the Project plan tab, using a work breakdown structure.
3. Give every task one owner, a start date and an end date; the duration calculates automatically.
4. Record dependencies so you can see which tasks must finish first.
5. Mark key milestones and agree the plan with your sponsor before work starts.
6. Update the Status column weekly and use it in your status report.

Tips

• Plan at a level of detail you can actually keep up to date.
• Add buffer to risky tasks rather than padding every estimate.
• Keep the plan visible: share the link instead of emailing copies.
• Re-baseline only through change control.

Dashboard (sample data)

Field	Value	Count
Owner	Business analyst	1
Owner	Delivery team	1
Owner	Project manager	4
Owner	Sponsor	1
Status	Not started	4
Status	In progress	1
Status	On hold	0
Status	Blocked	0
Status	Done	2

Project plan · Tasks, owners, dates and dependencies

ID	Phase	Task / deliverable	Owner	Start	End	Duration (days)	Depends on	Status	Milestone?
1.1	Initiation	Project charter approved	Sponsor	5 Jan 2026	9 Jan 2026	5		Done	Yes
1.2	Initiation	Stakeholder register	Project manager	7 Jan 2026	12 Jan 2026	6	1.1	Done	
2.1	Planning	Requirements workshop	Business analyst	13 Jan 2026	16 Jan 2026	4	1.2	In progress	
2.2	Planning	Work breakdown structure	Project manager	19 Jan 2026	21 Jan 2026	3	2.1	Not started	
2.3	Planning	Schedule and budget baseline	Project manager	22 Jan 2026	28 Jan 2026	7	2.2	Not started	Yes
3.1	Execution	Build release 1	Delivery team	2 Feb 2026	13 Mar 2026	40	2.3	Not started	
4.1	Closure	Handover and lessons learned	Project manager	16 Mar 2026	20 Mar 2026	5	3.1	Not started	Yes

Overview · One-page summary of the plan

Item	Details
Project name	
Sponsor	
Project manager	
Goal (SMART)	e.g. Launch the customer portal by 31 March to cut support calls by 30%
In scope	
Out of scope	
Key deliverables	
Budget	
Key risks	
Success criteria	